the pressure on Najibullah, and would threaten the stability of Pakistan. The decision to disengage would also leave the Mujahideens feeling betrayed and risk an eventual anti-American government in Afghanistan. Mujahideen military pressure has already forced extensive change and compromise on the Kabul regime. Continued pressure eventually will either defeat the regime militarily or will reach an accommodation with whatever is left in Kabul. Najibullah probably must depart under any scenario.

Two American intelligence organisations held differing views about the tactics of the mujahideen. The Defence Intelligence Agency (DIA) felt that the low-level harassment tactics of the mujahideen would not threaten the Najibullah regime in the foreseeable future and in fact Najibullah was stronger and with higher morale today than six months ago because of the surprising performance of the Afghan army and the dependable high level of Soviet support. However, the CIA felt that the mujahideen were following the same harassment tactics that succeeded against the Soviets and sufficient pressure was being generated to force the collapse of Najibullah's government.

The Final Assault

Ved Asthana met Massoud sometime in September 1990, a month after the fall of the Benazir Bhutto government in Pakistan. The Gulf War had already set the Middle East on fire and R&AW intelligence reports had suggested increasing terror activities in the Pakistan-Afghanistan border area. Najibullah was trying to rebuild the Afghan army but consistent attacks by resistance forces had reduced government influence to merely ten per cent of the region. Above all, Najibullah had decided to oust all militia groups from Kabul including the Juzjani militia